

The Japanese word is *chadō* — the way of tea — and at its formal height it is a discipline of years. At home, in winter, you can keep only its instinct: that making a hot drink slowly, with attention, is a way of marking the turn of the day. The point is not the tea. The point is the five minutes you give it.

Boil the water just off the rolling boil. Warm the pot first — a cast-iron *tetsubin* holds the heat through a long sit. Pour for two even if you are one; the second cup is for the

room. Carry it on a tray to the lowest, warmest light you own, and turn off the overhead on the way. Do not bring your phone. Watch the window go from grey to blue to black.

This is *datsuzoku*, the sixth Zen principle — a small, deliberate break from routine. Five minutes that belong to no task. By the time the cup is empty the light has gone, and you have, for once, watched it go rather than resented it.

---

### Cast-iron tetsubin teapot

Holds the heat through a long sit. The object the whole ritual turns on.

\$\$ [SHOP →](#)

---

### Stoneware tea cups, set of four

With saucers — pour for two even when you're one.

\$ [SHOP →](#)